API stands for Application Programming Interface. APIs can be paralleled to a set of protocols between different software programs to communicate with each other, that is, to share data and/or functionality with each other.

There are two types of APIs widely used:

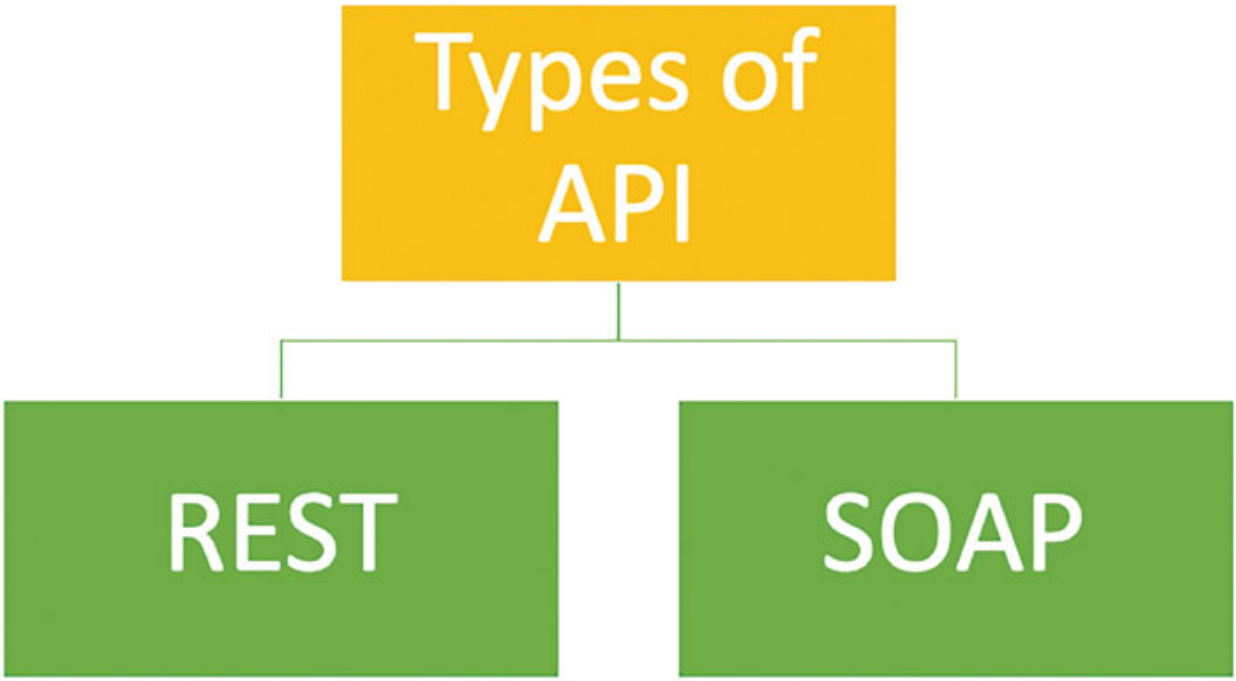


Figure 7.1: *Types of API*

REST

REST API stands for Representational State Transfer.

It is a single resource for multiple actions in the API layer and uses CRUD (Create, Read, Update, Delete) operations to manipulate and transform data.

SOAP

SOAP API stands for Simple Object Access Protocol.

It can be both stateful and stateless. It makes its calls using POST and also exposes the method calls that are done for communication and transfer of data packets.

Resources, Collections and Nesting Relationships